

1.4 Pre-production and planning documentation and techniques for characters and comics

Pre-production and planning for characters

- ☐ Character design (aesthetics)
- ☐ Character profiles

To include:

- Using a range of techniques for planning effective characters
 - thumb nailing
 - hand drawn drafts
 - using physical models for digital capture
 - digitally created drafts
- Using character profiles to plan the details of character behaviours/emotions, attributes, backstory, type or role (antagonist/protagonist)

Does not include:

- Any form of project management planning documentation including workplans and Gantt charts

Pre-production and planning for comics

- ☐ Plot structure
 - beginning – exposition, introduce character, setting, conflict
 - middle – rising action to climax or turning point
 - end – falling action and resolution
- ☐ The story arc
 - key parts of a storyline structure
 - graphical representation of the story arc
- ☐ Story script
- ☐ Storyboard
- ☐ Panel shape/styling and placement to create effective story flow
- ☐ Panel shot types and their meaning
 - close up/extreme close up
 - wide shot
 - over the shoulder
 - establishing shot
 - medium shot
- ☐ Panel content

To include:

- Planning comic plot structures
- Using story arc plans (graph style with time across the x axis and key points plotted and annotated along it)
- Using scripts to plan the communication within comics
- Planning panel shape, size and positioning to display different meanings
- Creating panel layout and story flow plans
- Using a range of different shot types to convey meaning in each comic panel
- Using pre-production and planning documentation such as visualisation diagrams and storyboards to draft out panel content

Does not include:

- Any form of project management planning documentation including workplans and Gantt charts